

Windows XP's service packs usually contain lot of security patches that plug security holes, updated drivers and enhancements to the operating system. There are two ways to update your system. One is going to the Windows Update Web site:

<http://update.microsoft.com/windowsupdate/v6/default.aspx?ln=en-us>



Enabling Automatic Updates

Here, you will be asked if you want to allow the site to scan your system to check what updates your system needs. If you allow it to, it presents you with a list of updates that are required. You can choose what updates you think you want, and download only those.

Second, you can configure your OS to automatically check for updates. In XP, updates are automated by default, and do not require manual intervention. But if you don't want Windows to update itself, or if you want to schedule the update for a different time or change the notification settings you can do so. To access Windows Update, go to Start > Control Panel > Automatic Updates (if you don't see 'Automatic Updates' in the Control Panel, switch to Classic View; if you find it here, go to Control Panel > System > Automatic Updates). Here, you'll see 'Notification Settings'.

You can select if you want to download the updates automatically and notify you when they're ready to install, or notify you before downloading them, or turn off updating completely. You may want to turn off updates or notify you before downloading to save bandwidth. One thing you should note is that this will update only the Windows XP operating system and not Microsoft programs such as Office.

Once the system has downloaded the updates, it will show up as a small icon in the System Tray informing you that the updates